

Lettering

Level 1





About the Course

Learn and practice lettering techniques to create meaningful and inspirational hand-lettered art. Lesson topics include serifed, sans-serifed, and script fonts, line width and value, guidelines, outlines, and shadow lines, key principles of design, dimension, and shading. Each term concludes with a project, and skills can be used to create beautiful collections of mottoes and quotes in a Commonplace Book or for display or gifts.



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for interested younger students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7+	Lettering: Level 1 1 time/week 20 min	The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Lettering: Level 1				
				Lettering: Level 1



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Lettering: Level 1

- ☐ Allow time for loading and viewing the tutorial video each time you begin a new style. Then, plan your lesson time accordingly.
- ☐ Purchase supplies, then organize and store them where they can be easily accessed.
- ☐ If you haven't done so already for Art Instruction lessons, prep your chalkboard before beginning lessons. (See video in Lesson 1)
- ☐ The best chalkboard option is to paint a wall that students can access during lesson time.

If that is not possible, a usable substitute would be to either paint the back of the drawing board used in art lessons or purchase a frameless chalkboard.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Lettering: Level 1



The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

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Cap Pencil Eraser



Fine Grit Sandpaper



Handheld Sharpener



Old Hand Towel



Q-Tips



White and Colored Chalk



Quick Links

Lettering: Level 1

∞ [Prepare Your Chalkboard](#)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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How To Teach



Warm Up

Have the students spend a few minutes warming up by practicing large arm movements on the chalkboard and drawing a few strokes they have already learned.



Observe

Look at the new stroke or letter together. Allow the students to articulate what they notice. How will they achieve the desired look?



Practice

Students should practice with a small piece of chalk (on its side) on the chalkboard first so that erasing is easy. Then have students practice the new stroke, letter, or letter combination with pen and paper. They should practice until they have six perfect examples before moving on to the next stroke.



Evaluate

Have the students self-evaluate. They may circle their best examples or reflect on which parts were done well and which ones need more practice.

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Term 1

WEEK 1

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 1

Chalk Lettering

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial and become familiar with your tools.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Intro and Tools

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"The ABCs of Chalk Lettering" Ch.1 p.3-7

→ PRACTICE

Prepare your chalkboard. Draw letters using shoulder muscles like in Art Instruction lessons.

• COMMONPLACE BOOK

Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

WEEK 2

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 2

Anatomy of Letters

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Anatomy of Letters

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Lowdown on Letters" Ch.1 p.8-9

→ PRACTICE

Draw your name. Use shoulder muscles and incorporate lettering aspects.

• COMMONPLACE BOOK

Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

WEEK 3

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 3

Sans Serif Style

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Sans Serif Style

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Sans Serif Characteristics; How to Draw a Sans Serif Style" Ch.1 p.10, 12

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

• COMMONPLACE BOOK

Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

WEEK 4

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 4

Sans Serif Style (cont.)

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ RECAP

Talk about the characteristics of the sans serif lettering style.

→ PRACTICE

Draw letters in sans serif style. Vary line width and value.

• COMMONPLACE BOOK

Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

WEEK 5

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 5

Serif Style

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Serif Style

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Serif Characteristics; How to Draw a Serif Style" Ch.1 p.11, 13

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

• COMMONPLACE BOOK

Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

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Term 1

WEEK 6	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 6 <i>Serif Style (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Talk about the characteristics of the serif lettering style. → PRACTICE Draw letters in serif style. Vary line width and value.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 7	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 7 <i>Script Style</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → VIEW Watch the tutorial. ∞ Video Link: Lettering: Script Style → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Script Characteristics; How to Draw a Script Style" Ch.1 p.11, 14 → PRACTICE Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 8	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 8 <i>Script Style (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Talk about the characteristics of the script lettering style. → PRACTICE Draw letters in script style. Vary line width and value.	
WEEK 9	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 9 <i>Chalkboard Project 1</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Put together all of the pieces learned this term, and plan a chalkboard project that includes all three lettering styles, varying line width and value. Complete it over three weeks.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 10	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 10 <i>Chalkboard Project 1 (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Work on term project.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 11	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 11 <i>Chalkboard Project 1 (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Work on term project.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 12	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Complete Book of Chalk Lettering	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

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Term 2

WEEK 1	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 13 <i>Choosing Lettering Styles</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Explain the difference between "The Big Three" lettering styles. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Choosing Lettering Styles; What Are Your Words Really Saying?" Ch.2 p.18-19 → PRACTICE Draw words using different lettering styles.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 2	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 14 <i>Choosing Lettering Styles (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Explain what different aspects affect the mood of a design. → PRACTICE Draw words using different styles to convey different moods. Vary line width and value.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 3	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 15 <i>Finding Inspiration</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Finding Inspiration, Sketching Designs" Ch.2 p.20 → PRACTICE Set aside an "inspiration space" in your Commonplace Book to collect inspirational quotes that you would like to use in your chalk designs this term. Spend time today searching for inspiration and adding to that list.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 4	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 16 <i>Finding Inspiration (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Tell about how to make pencil and paper sketches and their importance. → PRACTICE Do a few pencil and paper sketches of designs using quotes from your inspiration list.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 5	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 17 <i>Composition: Guidelines</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → VIEW Watch the tutorial. ∞ Video Link: Lettering: Composition: Guidelines → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Placing Chalk Guides" Ch.2 p.21 → PRACTICE Set up composition guidelines on the chalkboard for one of your pencil and paper sketches. Remember you are only practicing guidelines at this time. You are not completing projects with lettering.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 6	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 18 <i>Composition: Guidelines (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Set up composition guidelines on the chalkboard for more of your pencil and paper sketches. Remember you are only practicing guidelines at this time. You are not completing projects with lettering.	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.

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Term 2

WEEK 7	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 19 <i>Composition: Principles of Design</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS "Principles of Design; Design Dissected; How to Design a Chalk Layout" Ch.2 p.22-26 → VIEW Watch the tutorial ∞ Video Link: Lettering: Composition: Principles of Design	• COMMONPLACE BOOK Write beautiful quotes or mottoes with creative lettering.
WEEK 8	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 20 <i>Principles of Design (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → RECAP Choose one of the three designs and dissect it using the five main principles of design. ∞ Image Link: Dissecting Designs → PRACTICE Choose one of your pencil and paper sketches and rework the composition, incorporating the principles of design.	
WEEK 9	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 21 <i>Chalkboard Project 2</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Put together all of the pieces learned this term and plan a chalkboard project. Set up a composition using guidelines to incorporate principles of design. Vary the letter styles, line width, and value. Complete over three weeks.	
WEEK 10	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 22 <i>Chalkboard Project 2 (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Work on term project.	
WEEK 11	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 23 <i>Chalkboard Project 2 (cont.)</i> Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering → PRACTICE Work on term project.	
WEEK 12	20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Complete Book of Chalk Lettering	

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Term 3

WEEK 1

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 25

Shadow Lines

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Shadow Lines

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Adding Shadow Lines" Ch.3 p.30

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

→ NOTE

Keep the design for next week.

WEEK 2

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 26

Take Shadow Lines Further

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Take Shadow Lines Further

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Kicking Shadow Lines..." Ch.3 p.31

→ PRACTICE

Using the design from last week, follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from tutorial.

WEEK 3

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 27

Soft Shadow Lines

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Soft Shadow Lines

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Creating Soft Shadow Lines" Ch.3 p.32

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

WEEK 4

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 28

Drawing Dimension

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Drawing Dimension

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Drawing Dimension" Ch.3 p.33

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

WEEK 5

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 29

Overlapping Letters

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Overlapping Letters

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Overlapping Letters" Ch.3 p.34

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

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Term 3

WEEK 6

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 30

Shading with Ombre

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Shading with Ombre

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Yay, Ombre!" Ch.3 p.35

→ PRACTICE

Follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

→ NOTE

Keep the design for next week.

WEEK 7

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 31

Outlines

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Outlines

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Outlining Outlines" Ch.3 p.36

→ PRACTICE

Using the design from last week, follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

→ NOTE

Keep the design for next week.

WEEK 8

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 32

Controlling Dust

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ VIEW

Watch the tutorial.

∞ Video Link: Lettering: Controlling Dust

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

"Dust is Your Friend" Ch.3 p.37

→ PRACTICE

Using the design from last week, follow the steps in the book, incorporating tips from the tutorial.

WEEK 9

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 33

Chalkboard Project 3

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ PRACTICE

Put together all of the pieces learned this term and plan a chalkboard project. Set up a composition using guidelines to incorporate principles of design. Vary the letter styles, line width, and value. Focus on controlling dust, outlining and drawing dimensional letters. Complete over three weeks.

WEEK 10

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 34

Chalkboard Project 3 (cont.)

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ PRACTICE

Work on term project.

WEEK 11

20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 35

Chalkboard Project 3 (cont.)

Materials: The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

→ PRACTICE

Work on term project.

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Term 3

WEEK 12  **20m Lettering: Level 1 - Lesson 36**
Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Complete Book of Chalk Lettering

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Examination

- Term 1** · Show your completed Chalkboard Project 1 to an adult.
- Term 2** · Show your completed Chalkboard Project 2 to an adult.
· The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering: Explain your understanding of the five main principles of design.
- Term 3** · Show your completed Chalkboard Project 3 to an adult.
· The Complete Book of Chalk Lettering: Discuss why "chalk dust can be your friend."